

Curriculum Vitae

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RESEARCH TRAINING EXPERIENCE

Nov. 2025 – Current **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, Stanley S. Scott Cancer Center, School of Medicine, Louisiana State University Health Sciences Center, New Orleans, LA, USA.

Nov. 2021 – Sep. 2025 **Postdoctoral Research Fellow**, Cancer Epidemiology Division, Population Sciences in the Pacific Program, University of Hawai'i Cancer Center, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, HI, USA.

Oct. 2019 – Oct. 2021 **Postdoctoral Researcher**, College of Life Sciences, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China.

Sep. 2012 – Aug. 2013 **Undergraduate Research Trainee**, Innovation and Entrepreneurship Training Program, College of Life Sciences, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China. Project: *Investigating the role of RE-IIBP in the development of multiple myeloma*

EDUCATION

Sep. 2014 – Jun. 2019 **Ph.D.** in Genetics, College of Life Sciences, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China.

Sep. 2010 – Jun. 2014 **B.S.** in Biological Sciences, College of Life Sciences, Wuhan University (a Top 10 University in China mainland), Wuhan, China.

RESEARCH GRANT SUPPORT

Funded Grants

2026 – 2027 **LAUNCHED Pilot and Feasibility Grant** (NIDDK Grant U24 DK132740)

Role: **Principal Investigator**

Project: Integrative Proteome-Wide Association Study and Large Language Model (LLM)-Based Prioritization of Causal Protein Targets of Type 2 Diabetes

Total direct costs: \$35,000

2025 – 2026 **UCLA Leveraging Institutional Support for Talented, Upcoming Physicians and/or Scientists (LIFT-UP) Program** (NIDDK Grant U24 DK132746-01)

Role: **Principal Investigator**

Project: Investigation of DNA Methylation Biomarkers and Incidence Risk Prediction for Type 2 Diabetes in Native Hawaiians and East Asians

Total direct costs: \$40,000

Pending / Under Review Grant Applications

2026 – 2028 **Prostate Cancer Foundation Young Investigator Award**

Role: **Principal Investigator**

Project: Germline-to-Cell-State Mapping to Identify Actionable Drivers of Advanced Prostate Cancer
Total direct costs requested: \$210,000
Status: Submitted; under review

AWARDS AND HONORS

Postdoctoral Awards and Honors

2025 Research Corporation of the University of Hawai'i (RCUH) Outstanding Employees of the Year awards – Outstanding Employee Team

2025 One *International Journal of Cancer* article (*Associations between genetically predicted levels of blood metabolites and pancreatic cancer risk*) ranked among the journal's top 10 most-cited papers published in 2023.

2025 One *International Journal of Cancer* article (*Elucidating the role of blood metabolites on pancreatic cancer risk using two-sample Mendelian randomization analysis*) ranked among the journal's top 10 most-viewed papers published in 2023.

2023 Two studies (*Associations between genetically predicted levels of blood metabolites and pancreatic cancer risk* and *Identification of blood protein biomarkers associated with prostate cancer risk using genetic prediction models: analysis of over 140,000 subjects*) selected as research highlights by the National Cancer Institute's (NCI) Division of Cancer Control Epidemiology and Genomics Research Program (EGRP)

2022 The University of Hawai'i Cancer Center Travel Award, Honolulu, HI, USA

Predoctoral Awards and Honors

2018 The Third Prize, Youth Forum in 2018 Genetics Academic Association of Four Provinces in the Middle Reaches of the Yangtze River, Huangshan, Anhui, China

2017 The Second Prize, Youth Forum in 2017 Genetics Academic Association of Four Provinces in the Middle Reaches of the Yangtze River, Zhangjiajie, Hunan, China

2014 Advanced individual for graduate practice, Wuhan University, China

Undergraduate Awards and Honors

2013 Second-Class University-Wide Scholarship, Wuhan University, Wuhan, China

PUBLICATIONS

NIH Bibliography: <https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/myncbi/hua.zhong.2/bibliography/public/>

Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=LJSin0sAAAAJ&hl=zh-CN>

1404 Citations, h-index 24, i10-index 37

First/Co-First/Corresponding Author Publications

1. **Zhong H**, Zhu J, Liu S, Wu C, Wang L, Whelton S, Marshall C, Blaha M, Durda P, Guo X, Johnson C, Lin H, Taylor K, Tracy R, Yarden R, Manichaikul A, Rich S, Rotter J, Deo R, Dubin R, Ganz P, Wu L*. Proteome-wide association study of prostate cancer risk in racial and ethnic diverse populations. *Nature Communications*. 2025;17:3043
2. **Zhong H[†]**, Zhu J[†], Liu S[†], Wong H, Zhang Y, Luu H, Wu Q, Wang X, Wu L*. Cross-ancestry proteome-wide Mendelian randomization study identifies likely causal proteins for cardiovascular diseases. *Molecular Genetics and Genomics*. 2025 (Accepted).

3. **Zhong H**, Zhu J, Liu S, Zhou D, Long Q, Wu C, Zhao B, Cheng C, Yang Y, Wu Q, Wu Y, Li C, Wang Z, Wu JY, Guo X, Zhi D, Deng Y, Wu L*. Linking DNA methylation in brain regions to Alzheimer's disease risk: a Mendelian randomization study. *Human Molecular Genetics*. 2025;34(12):1026–1033.
4. **Zhong H**, Liu S, Zhu J, Xu T, Yu H, Wu L*. Elucidating the role of blood metabolites on pancreatic cancer risk using two-sample Mendelian randomization analysis. *International Journal of Cancer*. 2024;154(5): 852-862.
5. **Zhong H**, Liu S, Zhu J, Wu L*. Associations between genetically predicted levels of blood metabolites and pancreatic cancer risk. *International Journal of Cancer*. 2023;153(1): 103-110.
6. **Zhong H**, Zhu J, Liu S, Ghoneim DH, Surendran P, Liu T, Fahle S, Butterworth A, Alam M, Deng H, Yu H, Wu C, Wu L*. Identification of blood protein biomarkers associated with prostate cancer risk using genetic prediction models: analysis of over 140,000 subjects. *Human Molecular Genetics*. 2023;32(22): 3181-3193.
7. **Zhong H[†]**, Liu S[†], Cao F, Zhao Y, Zhou J, Tang F, Peng Z, Li Y, Xu S, Wang C*, Yang G*, Li Z*. Dissecting tumor antigens and immune subtypes of glioma to develop mRNA vaccine. *Frontiers in Immunology*. 2021;12:709986
8. **Zhong H[†]**, Liu S[†], Zhao G, Zhang C, Peng Z, Wang Z, Yang J, Li Y*. Genetic diversity relationship between grain quality and appearance in rice. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2021;12:708996.
9. **Zhong H[†]**, Liu S[†], Meng X, Sun T, Deng Y, Kong W, Peng Z, Li Y*. Uncovering the genetic mechanisms regulating panicle architecture in rice with GPWAS and GWAS. *BMC Genomics*. 2021;22:86.
10. **Zhong H[†]**, Liu S[†], Sun T, Kong W, Deng X, Peng Z, Li Y*. Multi-locus genome-wide association studies for five yield-related traits in rice. *BMC Plant Biology*. 2021;21:364.
11. Liu S[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Wang Q, Liu C, Li T, Peng Z, Zhang L, Chen F, Li Y, Liao J, Huang Y, Wang Z*. Global analysis of UDP glucose pyrophosphorylase gene family in plants: conserved evolution involved in cell death. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2021;12:681719.
12. Mao K[†], Tan Q[†], Huang Q[†], Wang S[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Liao Y, Xiao W, Xia H, Tan X, Luo P, Xu J, Long D, Jin Y*. Proteomics of extracellular vesicles in plasma reveals the characteristics and residual traces of COVID-19 patients without underlying diseases after 3 months of recovery. *Cell Death & Disease*. 2021;12(6):541.
13. Cao F, Fan Y, Yu Y, Yang G, **Zhong H***. Dissecting prognosis modules and biomarkers in glioblastoma based on weighted gene co-expression network analysis. *Cancer Management and Research*. 2021;13:5477–5489.
14. Cao F, Wang C, Long D, Mao K, **Zhong H***. Network-based meta-analysis of transcriptomic studies in dissecting genetic signatures for LPS-induced acute lung injury. *Inflammation*. 2021;44(6):2486–2498.
15. Zhang Q[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Fan Y, Liu Q, Song J, Yao S*, Cao F*. Immune and clinical features of CD96 expression in glioma by in silico analysis. *Frontiers in Bioengineering and Biotechnology*. 2020;8:592.
16. Cao F, Guo Y, Zhang Q, Fan Y, Song J, Liu Q, **Zhong H***, Yao S*. Integration of transcriptome resequencing and quantitative proteomics analyses of collagenase VII-induced intracerebral hemorrhage in mice. *Frontiers in Genetics*. 2020;11:551065.
17. Zhang C[†], Gong R[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Dai C, Zhang R, Dong J, Li Y, Liu S*, Hu J*. Integrated multi-locus genome-wide association studies and transcriptome analysis for seed yield and yield-related traits in *Brassica napus*. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2023;14:1153000.
18. Liu S[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Meng X, Sun T, Li Y, Pinson SRM, Chang SKC, Peng Z*. Genome-wide association studies of ionomic and agronomic traits in the USDA mini-core collection of rice and comparative analyses of different mapping methods. *BMC Plant Biology*. 2020;20(1):441.

19. **Zhong H[†]**, Liu C[†], Kong W, Zhang Y, Zhao G, Sun T, Li Y*. Effect of multi-allele combination on rice grain size based on prediction of regression equation model. *Molecular Genetics and Genomics*. 2020;295(2):465–474.
20. Zhou J[†], **Zhong H[†]**, Zhang J, Jin S, Roudi R, Ma H*. Development and validation of a prognostic signature for malignant pleural mesothelioma. *Frontiers in Oncology*. 2019;9:78.
21. **Zhong H**, Kong W, Gong Z, Fang X, Deng X, Liu C, Li Y*. Evolutionary analyses reveal diverged patterns of SQUAMOSA promoter binding protein-like gene family in the *Oryza* genus. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2019;10:565.
22. **Zhong H[†]**, Zhang H[†], Guo R, Wang Q, Huang X, Liao J, Li Y, Huang Y, Wang Z*. Characterization and functional divergence of a novel DUF668 gene family in rice based on comprehensive expression patterns. *Genes*. 2019;10:980.

Other Peer-Reviewed Publications

23. Tian Y., Wong J., McDonnell S., **Zhong H.**, Wu L., Larson N., Manley B., Wang L*. nanoASM: Long-Read Allele-Specific DNA Methylation Profiling Enables Functional Annotation of Regulatory Noncoding Variants in Human Prostate Tissues. *bioRxiv*, 2026: 2026.06. 17.732357.
24. Zhu J[†], Liu S[†], **Zhong H**, Zhou D, Long Q, Yang X, Wu Q, Cheng C, Wu J, Hung L, Wang J, Zhao B, Wu C, Zhang Z, Wu L*. Investigating causal associations among inflammatory proteins, blood metabolites, and Alzheimer's disease risk. *BMC Psychiatry*. 2025. Accepted.
25. Sun Y, Zhu J, **Zhong H**, Zhang Z, Wang F, Nakamura A, Liu Y, Liu J, Yu J, Zeng G, Lin X, Zhou D, Wu C, Wang L, Deng Y, Wu L*. Transcriptome-wide association study identified novel blood tissue gene biomarkers for prostate cancer risk. *The Prostate*. 2025; 85(6): 567-579.
26. Liu S, Zhu J, Green D, **Zhong H**, Long Q, Wu C, Wang L, Deng Y, Wu L*. Integrating multi-omics data to uncover prostate tissue DNA methylation biomarkers and target genes for prostate cancer risk. *Molecular Carcinogenesis*. 2025. 64(1): 83-90.
27. Liu S, **Zhong H**, Zhu J, Wu L*. Identification of blood metabolites associated with risk of Alzheimer's disease by integrating genomics and metabolomics data. *Molecular Psychiatry*. 2024; 29(4): 1153-1162
28. Liu S, **Zhong H**, Zhu J, Wu Y, Deng Y, Wu L*. Regulome-wide association study identifies genetically driven accessible regions associated with pancreatic cancer risk. *International Journal of Cancer*. 2024; 154(4): 670-678.
29. Liu S, Zhu J, **Zhong H**, Wu C, Xue H, Darst BF, Guo X, Durda P, Tracy RP, Liu Y, Johnson WC, Taylor KD, Manichaikul AW, Goodarzi MO, Gerszten RE, Clish CB, Chen YI, Highland H, Haiman CA, Gignoux CR, Lange L, Conti DV, Raffield LM, Wilkens L, Le Marchand L, North KE, Young KL, Loos RJ, Buyske S, Matise T, Peters U, Kooperberg C, Reiner AP, Yu B, Boerwinkle E, Sun Q, Rooney MR, Echouffo-Tcheugui JB, Daviglus ML, Qi Q, Mancuso N, Li C, Deng Y, Manning A, Meigs JB, Rich SS, Rotter JI, Wu L*. Identification of proteins associated with type 2 diabetes risk in diverse racial and ethnic populations. *Diabetologia*. 2024; 67(12): 2754-2770
30. Yu J, Zhu J, **Zhong H**, Zhang Z, Liu J, Lin X, Zeng G, Zhang M, Wu C, Deng Y, Sun Y*, Wu L*. Age-related hearing impairment: genome and blood methylome data integration reveals candidate epigenetic biomarkers. *OMICS: A Journal of Integrative Biology*. 2024; 28(12): 620-631
31. Zhu J[†], Liu S[†], Walker K, **Zhong H**, Ghoneim D, Zhang Z, Surendran P, Fahle S, Butterworth A, Alam M, Deng H, Wu C, Wu L*. Associations between genetically predicted plasma protein levels and Alzheimer's disease risk: a study using genetic prediction models. *Alzheimer's Research & Therapy*. 2024;16(1):1–16.
32. Zhu J[†], Wu K[†], Liu S[†], Masca A, **Zhong H**, Yang T, Ghoneim D, Surendran P, Liu T, Yao Q, Liu T, Fahle S, Butterworth A, Alam M, Vadgama J, Deng Y, Deng H, Wu C, Wu Y, Wu L*. Proteome-wide association study and functional validation identify novel protein markers for pancreatic ductal adenocarcinoma. *GigaScience*. 2024;13:giae012.

33. Mei C, Zhan J, Zhu S, Zhang Y, Xiong CE, Wang J, Xu Y, **Zhong H**, Cheng J*. Advances of therapy for Alzheimer's disease: an updated review. *Brain-X*. 2024;2(3).
34. Sun Y, Zhu J, Yang Y, Zhang Z, **Zhong H**, Zeng G, Zhou D, Nowakowski R, Long J, Wu C, Wu L*. Identification of candidate DNA methylation biomarkers related to Alzheimer's disease risk by integrating genome and blood methylome data. *Translational Psychiatry*. 2023;13(1):387.
35. Xu L[†], Liu YE[†], Chen X, **Zhong H**, Wang Y*. Ferroptosis in life: to be or not to be. *Biomedicine & Pharmacotherapy*. 2023;159:114241.
36. Sun Y, Bae Y, Zhu J, Zhang Z, **Zhong H**, Yu J, Wu C, Wu L*. A splicing transcriptome-wide association study identifies novel altered splicing for Alzheimer's disease susceptibility. *Neurobiology of Disease*. 2023;106209.
37. Sun Y, Bae Y, Zhu J, Zhang Z, **Zhong H**, Cheng C, Deng Y, Wu C, Wu L*. A splicing transcriptome-wide association study identifies candidate altered splicing for prostate cancer risk. *OMICS: A Journal of Integrative Biology*. 2023;27(8): 372-380.
38. Kong W, Deng X, Yang J, Zhang C, Sun T, Ji W, **Zhong H**, Fu X, Li Y*. High-resolution bin-based linkage mapping uncovers the genetic architecture and heterosis-related loci of plant height in indica-japonica derived populations. *The Plant Journal*. 2022;110:814–827.
39. Sun T, Wang T, Qiang Y, Zhao G, Yang J, **Zhong H**, Peng X*, Yang J*, Li Y*. CBL-interacting protein kinase OsCIPK18 regulates the response of ammonium toxicity in rice roots. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2022;13:863283.
40. Deng X, Kong W, Sun T, Zhang C, **Zhong H**, Zhao G, Liu X, Qiang Y, Li Y*. Bin mapping-based QTL analyses using three genetic populations derived from indica-japonica crosses uncover multiple grain shape heterosis-related loci in rice. *The Plant Genome*. 2022;15(1).
41. Mao K, Luo P, Geng W, Xu J, Liao Y, **Zhong H**, Ma P, Tan Q, Xia H, Duan L, Song S, Huang Q, Long D, Jin Y*. An integrative transcriptomic and metabolomic study reveals that melatonin plays a protective role in chronic lung inflammation by reducing necroptosis. *Frontiers in Immunology*. 2021;12:668002.
42. Wang Z*, Wang Q, Wei L, Shi Y, Li T, Hu K, Liu S, **Zhong H**, Liao J, Li Y, Zhang H, Huang Y. UDP-N-acetylglucosamine pyrophosphorylase 2 and 1 perform synergetic functions for leaf survival in rice. *Frontiers in Plant Science*. 2021;12:685102.
43. Kong W, Zhang C, Zhang S, Qiang Y, Zhang Y, **Zhong H**, Li Y*. Uncovering novel QTLs and candidate genes of salt tolerance in rice with linkage mapping, RTM-GWAS, and RNA-seq. *Rice*. 2021;14(1):1–12.
44. Guo X, Jiang S, Zhang L, Hu J, Edelbek D, Feng Y, Yang Z, Hu P, **Zhong H**, Yang G*, Yang F*. Berberine exerts its antineoplastic effects by reversing the Warburg effect via downregulation of the Akt/mTOR/GLUT1 signaling pathway. *Oncology Reports*. 2021;46(6):1–12.
45. He Y, Li H, Yao J, **Zhong H**, Kuang Y, Li X, Bian W*. HO-1 knockdown upregulates the expression of VCAM-1 to induce neutrophil recruitment during renal ischemia-reperfusion injury. *International Journal of Molecular Medicine*. 2021;48(4):1–11.
46. Mao K, Geng W, Liao Y, Luo P, **Zhong H**, Ma P, Xu J, Zhang S, Tan Q, Jin Y*. Identification of robust genetic signatures associated with lipopolysaccharide-induced acute lung injury onset and astaxanthin therapeutic effects by integrative analysis of RNA sequencing data and GEO datasets. *Aging*. 2020;12(18):18716–18740.
47. Kong W, Zhang C, Qiang Y, **Zhong H**, Zhao G, Li Y*. Integrated RNA-seq analysis and meta-QTL mapping provide insights into cold stress response in rice seedling roots. *International Journal of Molecular Sciences*. 2020;21:4615.
48. Kong W, Gong Z, **Zhong H**, Zhang Y, Zhao G, Deng X, Liu C, Zhang C, Li Y*. Expansion and evolutionary patterns of glycosyltransferase family 8 in Gramineae crop genomes and their expression under salt and cold stresses in *Oryza sativa* ssp. *japonica*. *Biomolecules*. 2019;9(5):188.

49. Deng X, An B, **Zhong H**, Yang J, Kong W, Li Y*. A novel insight into functional divergence of the MST gene family in rice based on comprehensive expression patterns. *Genes*. 2019;10:239.
50. Kong W, **Zhong H**, Gong Z, Fang X, Sun T, Deng X, Li Y*. Meta-analysis of salt stress transcriptome responses in different rice genotypes at the seedling stage. *Plants*. 2019;8:64.
51. Kong W, **Zhong H**, Deng X, Gautam M, Gong Z, Zhang Y, Zhao G, Liu C, Li Y*. Evolutionary analysis of GH3 genes in six *Oryza* species/subspecies and their expression under salinity stress in *Oryza sativa* ssp. *japonica*. *Plants*. 2019;8:30.

† These authors contributed equally to this work * Corresponding author

INVITED TALKS AND PRESENTATIONS

May 2024 Hua Zhong. Integrating Multi-Omics Data to Improve Cancer Etiology Understanding and Risk Assessment. Invited presentation, College of Medicine, University of Kentucky, Lexington, Kentucky, USA.

Mar. 2023 Hua Zhong. Identification of Novel Protein and Metabolite Biomarkers for Cancer Risk Using Genetic Instruments. Invited presentation, Experimental Biology Research in Progress Seminar, University of Hawai'i Cancer Center, Honolulu, Hawaii, USA.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Poster Presentations

2026 Hua Zhong, Shuai Liu, Jingjing Zhu, Lang Wu. Spatial Mapping of Pancreatic Cancer Genetic Risk in Healthy Human Pancreas. Presented at 2026 Louisiana Cancer Research Center Cancer Research Symposium, Xavier University of Louisiana, LA, USA.

2023 Hua Zhong, Shuai Liu, Jingjing Zhu, Lang Wu. Associations between genetically predicted levels of blood metabolites and pancreatic cancer risk. Presented at Biomedical Sciences and Health Disparities Symposium, John A. Burns School of Medicine, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, HI, USA.

2022 Hua Zhong, Shuai Liu, Jingjing Zhu, Lang Wu. Associations between genetically predicted levels of blood metabolites and pancreatic cancer risk. Presented at American Society of Human Genetics (ASHG), Los Angeles, CA, USA.

Oral Presentations

2018 Hua Zhong. Indica rice genome sequencing and high-precision genetic maps assisted in the mapping of QTLs related to agronomic traits. Oral presentation at the 2018 Youth Forum of the Genetics Academic Association of Four Provinces in the Middle Reaches of the Yangtze River, Huangshan, Anhui, China.

2017 Hua Zhong. Genomics and transcriptomics study of rice domestication in *Oryza rufipogon* and *Oryza nivara*. Oral presentation at the 2017 Youth Forum of the Genetics Academic Association of Four Provinces in the Middle Reaches of the Yangtze River, Zhangjiajie, Hunan, China.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Spring 2026 | Lecturer

AI-Enhanced Introduction to Bioinformatics: From Omics Data Analysis to LLM-Assisted Research Workflows

In-person hands-on training course offered by the Bioinformatics Core, LSUHSC; 15 contact hours. Topics include foundational bioinformatics, omics data analysis, reproducible research workflows, and LLM-assisted approaches for coding, literature review, workflow development, and scientific communication.

Spring 2021 | Lecturer

Gene Expression Omnibus (GEO) Data Mining and Meta-Analysis

Online course; 49 instructional chapters, 12 contact hours, 98 students. Covered GEO database retrieval, transcriptomic data preprocessing, differential expression analysis, meta-analysis, enrichment analysis, and visualization.

Summer 2017 | Teaching Assistant

In-depth Next Generation Sequencing Data Analysis

Biotrainee in-person training program; three-course module, one week; 50 students.

Fall 2013 | Teaching Assistant

Molecular Biology (0700163)

Undergraduate course, Wuhan University. Instructor: Prof. Qingzhen Liu.

RESEARCH MENTORING

Graduate Students

Jun. 2026 – Current **Chancen Law**, A.B. Candidate in Biomedical Engineering & Neuroscience, Harvard University, U54 Summer program. Project Title: *Spatial Mapping of Pancreatic Cancer Genetic Risk in Healthy Human Pancreas*.

Jan. 2026 – Current **Nubaira Rizvi**, Ph.D. Candidate in Public Health, Department of Biostatistics and Data Science, Louisiana State University, Project Title: *Discovering Protein Biomarkers and Protein–Environment Interactions for Atherosclerotic Cardiovascular Disease Susceptibility*.

Jan. 2026 – Current **Oluwafunmibi O. Fasanya**, Ph.D. Candidate in Public Health, Department of Biostatistics and Data Science, Louisiana State University, Project Title: *Genetically Predicted Protein Biomarkers and Protein–Environment Interactions in Heart Failure, Stroke, and Atrial Fibrillation*.

Jan. 2026 – Current **Amjila Bam**, Ph.D. Candidate in Public Health, Department of Biostatistics and Data Science, Louisiana State University, Project Title: *Identifying Protein Biomarkers and Protein–Environment Interactions for Lung and Breast Cancer Risk*.

Undergraduate Students

Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2025 & Jun. 2026 – Current **Kaao Yuen**, A.B. Candidate in Biomedical Engineering & Neuroscience, Harvard University, University of Hawai'i Cancer Center U54 Summer program. Project Title: *Identifying Cell-Type Specific Risk Genes for Prostate Cancer*.

Jun. 2024 – Sep. 2025 **Salvador Simpson**, M.S. Candidate in Molecular Bioscience & Bioengineering-MS program, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa. Thesis title: *Red Blood Cell Polyunsaturated Fatty Acid Levels and Pancreatic Cancer Risk: Findings from the Southern Community Cohort Study* (Manuscript preparing).

Jun. 2024 – Jul. 2024 **Adam Rui**, B.A. Candidate in Data Science, University of California, Riverside, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa 2024 Summer Intern Program. Project Title: *Blood polyunsaturated fatty acids and pancreatic cancer risk in understudied populations*.

Jun. 2023 – Jul. 2023 **Dylan Green**, B.A. Candidate in Biotechnology, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, 2023 Summer Intern Program. Project Title: *Integrating Multi-Omics Data to Uncover Prostate Tissue DNA Methylation Biomarkers and Target Genes for Prostate Cancer Risk* (Published in *Molecular Carcinogenesis*. 2025. 64(1): 83-90).

Jun. 2022 – Aug. 2022 **Cassidy Silva**, B.A. Candidate in Public Health, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, 2022 Summer Intern Program. Project Title: *Identifying associations between predicted metabolite levels in the cerebrospinal fluid and Alzheimer's disease risk*.

Sep. 2018 – Jun. 2019 **Chang Liu**, B.A. Candidate in Biology, Wuhan University, 2018-2019 Undergraduate Scientific Research Program. Project Title: *Effect of Multi-Allele Combination on Rice Grain Size Based on Prediction of Regression Equation Model* (Published in *Molecular Genetics and Genomics*. 2019, 295(2):465-474).

High School Student

Dec. 2022 – Jun. 2023 **Shuang Liang**, Mid-Pacific Institute, Honolulu, HI (currently Biology major at Boston University). Participated in laboratory group meetings and scientific discussions, gaining exposure to cancer epidemiology, genetics, and biomedical research.

EDITORIAL & REFEREEING ACTIVITIES

Editorial Board Appointments

2025 – Present Associate Board Member, *Advanced Genetics*

2025 – Present Youth Editorial Board Member, *Med Research*

2023 – Present Youth Editorial Board Member, *Brain-X* (2025 Impact Factor 6.4, JCR Q1)

Guest Editorial Service

Co-Guest Editor, *Frontiers in Immunology*

2024–2025 Unraveling Sex Disparities in Cancer Immunotherapy: Hormonal and Genetic Influences

2024 Crosstalk in Ferroptosis, Immunity & Inflammation

2023 Immunological Issues of Allo- and Xeno-Islet Transplantation

Co-Guest Editor, *Frontiers in Medicine*

2023–2024 Therapeutic Targets and Clinical Management of Intermediate-Advanced Gastroenterological Malignancies

Co-Guest Editor, *Technology in Cancer Research & Treatment*

2023–2024 Targeting Mitochondria in Cancer Metabolism

Lead Guest Editor, *Frontiers in Genetics*

2023–2024 Functional Study of Novel Variants of Uncertain Significance in Single-Gene Inherited Disease

2022–2023 Advances in Transcriptomics Research and Their Applications in Human Diseases

2020–2021 Decoding Connections between Phenotype and Genotype using Machine Learning

Additional guest editorial service: *Plants* and *Life*, covering bioinformatics, plant genetics, and molecular breeding topics.

Journal Reviewing

Selected peer reviewer for journals in cancer research, genetics, genomics, bioinformatics, and molecular medicine, including: *Cancer Letters*; *BMC Genomics*; *BMC Cancer*; *BMC Bioinformatics*; *Frontiers in Immunology*; *Frontiers in Oncology*; *Frontiers in Genetics*; *Biomedicine & Pharmacotherapy*; *International Journal of Biological Sciences*; *Journal of Cellular and Molecular Medicine*; *Technology in Cancer Research & Treatment*.

Total peer-review service: 100+ manuscript reviews across biomedical, genomics, oncology, and computational biology journals.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2025 – Present Associate Member, Louisiana Cancer Research Center

2024 – Present Associate Member, American Association for Cancer Research (AACR)

2014 – 2021 Member, Hubei provincial Genetic Society, China

INTRAMURAL COMMITTEE, ORGANIZATIONAL, AND VOLUNTEER SERVICE

Apr. 2023 Judge for graduate students' posters, John A. Burns School of Medicine, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, HI, USA.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT/ADDITIONAL TRAINING

2026 LCRC AI Hands-On Workshop, Louisiana Cancer Research Center/Tulane Cancer Center, New Orleans, LA. Three-hour hands-on workshop on practical AI applications, including ChatGPT, for cancer and life-science research, scientific writing, and academic workflows.

2025 GUMSHOE Training in Advanced Grant Writing, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Honolulu, HI

2024 PIKO Specific Aims Workshop, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Honolulu, HI

2022 Bioinformatics Data Science Workshops, John A. Burns School of Medicine, University of Hawai'i at Mānoa, Honolulu, HI

2019 Computational Thinking of Problem Solving, University of Pennsylvania, Online

MEDIA REPORT

2024 UH News. "National Cancer Institute highlights UH research." Featured two studies on genetically predicted metabolites/proteins and cancer risk. (<https://www.hawaii.edu/news/2024/02/16/nci-highlights-uh-research/>)